Justification for the award. The justification for the award must contain both the basis for the award **and** an explanation of how the award amount was determined.

Justification :

Basis for the nomination. Keep in mind that special act/service awards are not based on general overall performance during a rating period but are based on a specific act or service the employee performed that is worthy of recognition. An example of a special act/service is exceptional work on a special project or while on detail, or performing assigned responsibilities in an exceptional manner under difficult, unusual, and/or complicated circumstances. Be as specific as possible as to what the employee did, describe any obstacles the employee had to overcome in performing the act or service; and address the impact/significance of the employee's contributions.

How the award amount was determined. If you can identify tangible benefits (e.g., the special act or service saved the government xxx dollars), then use the awards table for tangible benefits. If the benefits are intangible, then use the table for intangible benefits, identifying both the extent and value of the employee's contribution. In some cases, there may be both tangible and intangible benefits. If so, describe both in explaining how the recommended award amount was determined. When using the table for intangible benefits, you will see there is a range for the award amount. If you are recommending an award amount at the high end of the range, explain why you are recommending the higher-end award amount.